Francis J. DiTraglia

Contact Information

Department of Economics
University of Oxford
Manor Road, Oxford OX1 3UQ
United Kingdom

Webpage: https://ditraglia.com
Email: francis.ditraglia@economics.ox.ac.uk

Research Interests

Econometrics, Bayesian Inference, Applied Microeconomics, AI Safety

Academic Positions

Associate Professor of Economics, University of Oxford, Oxford, UK, 2019–Present

Resident Scholar, Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago, Chicago, IL, July–December 2025

Assistant Professor of Economics, University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia, PA, 2013–2019

Lecturer in Economics, University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia, PA, 2012–2013

Other Affiliations

Tutor and Fellow in Economics, Lady Margaret Hall Oxford, 2019–Present

Visiting Researcher, Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago, 2019–2020, 2022–Present

Associate Member, Nuffield College Oxford, 2023–Present

Resident Member, London Initiative for Safe AI (LISA), September 2026–Present

Visiting Researcher, Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia, 2016–2019

Faculty Affiliate, Warren Center for Network and Data Sciences, University of Pennsylvania, 2013–2019

Education

Ph.D., Economics, University of Cambridge, Cambridge, UK, 2013

M.A., Economics, University of California San Diego, La Jolla, CA, 2009

M.Sc., Statistics with Distinction, University of St Andrews, St Andrews, UK, 2007

B.A., Economics and Mathematics, Phi Beta Kappa, *summa cum laude*,
College of William & Mary, Williamsburg, VA, 2006

Publications

Structured Payment in Pawnshop Borrowing: Mandates vs. Choice (with Craig McIntosh, Isaac Meza, Joyce Sadka, and Enrique Seira), *Review of Economic Studies*, Forthcoming.

Efficient Semiparametric Estimation of Marginal Treatment Effects with Genetic Instrumental Variables (with Ashish Patel and Stephen Burgess), *Annals of Applied Statistics*, Forthcoming.

Environmental Lead Risk in the 21st Century (with Mengli Chen, Ludovica Gazze, Reshmi Das, Jerome Nriagu, Yigal Erel, Edward Boyle, Caroline Taylor, and Dominik Weiss), *Communications Earth & Environment*, 2025, 6:776.

Selecting Invalid Instruments to Improve Mendelian Randomization with Two-Sample Summary Data (with Ashish Patel, Verena Zuber, and Stephen Burgess), *Annals of Applied Statistics*, 2024, 18 (2), pp. 1729–1749.

Hidden Hazards and Screening Policy: Predicting Undetected Lead Exposure in Illinois (with Ali Abbasi, Ludovica Gazze, and Bridget Pals), *Journal of Health Economics*, 2023, 90:102783.

Identifying Causal Effects in Experiments with Spillovers and Non-compliance (with Camilo García-Jimeno, Rossa O'Keeffe-O'Donovan, and Alejandro Sánchez-Becerra), *Journal of Econometrics*, 2023, 235 (2), pp. 1589–1624.

A Framework for Eliciting, Incorporating, and Disciplining Identification Beliefs in Linear Models (with Camilo García-Jimeno), *Journal of Business & Economic Statistics*, 2021, 39 (4), pp. 1038–1053.

Identifying the Effect of a Mis-classified, Binary, Endogenous Regressor (with Camilo García-Jimeno), *Journal of Econometrics*, 2019, 209 (2), pp. 376–390.

A Generalized Focused Information Criterion for GMM (with Minsu Chang), *Journal of Applied Econometrics*, 2018, 33 (3), pp. 378–397.

Using Invalid Instruments on Purpose: Focused Moment Selection and Averaging for GMM *Journal of Econometrics*, 2016, 195 (2), pp. 187–208.

Portfolio Selection: An Extreme Value Approach (with Jeffrey Gerlach), *Journal of Banking & Finance*, 2013, 37 (2), pp. 305–323.

Measuring Altruism in a Public Goods Experiment: A Comparison of U.S. and Czech Subjects (with Lisa Anderson and Jeffrey Gerlach), *Experimental Economics*, 2011, 14 (3), pp. 426–437.

Yes, Wall Street, There is a January Effect! Evidence from Laboratory Auctions (with Lisa Anderson and Jeffrey Gerlach), *Journal of Behavioral Finance*, 2007, 8 (1), pp. 1–8.

Working Papers

Bayesian Double Machine Learning for Causal Inference (with Laura Liu)

Experimenting with Spillovers: A Guide for Practitioners (with Alejandro Sánchez-Becerra), *Invited Chapter, Oxford Handbook of Impact Evaluation*

Works in Progress

Inference for the 21st Century (with Frank Schorfheide)

Bayesian Causal Inference and Orthogonality in High Dimensions (with Laura Liu)

Robustness at Scale: How fragile are empirical economic results? (with Johanna Einsiedler and Elizabeth Rhodes)

ECLIPS: the Elevated Childhood Lead Interagency Prevalence Study (with Ludovica Gazze et al.)

To Link or Not to Link? Estimating Long-run Treatment Effects from Historical Data (with Camilo García-Jimeno and Ezra Karger)

A History of Violence: Forced Displacement and *de facto* Land Reform in Rural Colombia (with Camilo García-Jimeno)

Grants

UKRI Cross Research Council Responsive Mode (CRCRM) – "Elevated Childhood Lead Interagency Prevalence Study (ECLIPS)," Project Co-lead, £666,708 (fEC), January 2025 – March 2027

UKRI Metascience Research Grant – "Fostering a Dynamic Academic Ecosystem: Innovative Platforms and Methodologies for Econometrics," Project Co-lead, £200,000 (fEC), June 2025 – November 2027

Oxford Social Sciences Division Teaching Development and Enhancement Project Award – "Adapting Core Empirical Research Methods for the AI Era," January 2025 – June 2025

Oxford Social Sciences Division Integrated Impact Grant – "Mapping Disparities in Childhood Lead Exposure," Summer 2023

Oxford Public Policy Challenge Fund Award – "Mapping Disparities in Childhood Lead Exposure in England," December 2021 – May 2022

John Fell OUP Research Fund Pump-priming Grant – "Identifying Causal Effects in Experiments with Social Interactions and Non-compliance," January 2020 – December 2023

Oxford Social Sciences Division Teaching Development and Enhancement Project Award – "Core Empirical Research Methods," June 2021 – June 2022

Center for Teaching and Learning Course Development Grant (UPenn) – "Statistical Learning and Causal Inference for Economics," Spring 2018

University Research Foundation Award (UPenn) – "A Framework for Eliciting, Incorporating and Disciplining Identification Beliefs in Linear Models," Spring 2016 – Spring 2017

School of Arts and Sciences Research Opportunity Grant (UPenn) – "A Framework for Eliciting, Incorporating and Disciplining Identification Beliefs in Linear Models," Spring 2016 – Spring 2017

Honors and Awards

Oxford Social Sciences Division Teaching Excellence Award, 2026

Kravis Award for Outstanding Undergraduate Teaching in Economics, UPenn, 2014 and 2017

Cambridge International Scholarship, 2009–2012

Humane Studies Fellowship, 2009–2012

Economics Department Fellowship, UCSD, 2007–2008

Rotary Ambassadorial Scholarship, St Andrews, 2006–2007

Lord Botetourt Medal (equivalent of valedictorian), William & Mary, 2006

Cissy Patterson Prize in Mathematics, William & Mary, 2006

Class of 1940 Scholarship, William & Mary, 2004–2006

Teaching

Short Courses:	Treatment Effects: The Basics (Oxford Economics Spring School), Treatment Effects: Beyond the Basics (Oxford Economics Summer School)
Oxford:	Treatment Effects (Grad), Limited Dependent Variables (Grad), Empirical Research Methods (Grad), Econometrics (Undergrad), Behavioral and Experimental Economics (Undergrad), Introductory Probability and Statistics (Undergrad)
UPenn:	Model Selection and Statistical Learning (Grad), Statistics for Economists (Undergrad), Statistical Learning and Causal Inference (Undergrad)

Software

`ivreg2r`:	R package for instrumental variables and GMM estimation with diagnostics (CRAN, 2026). Part of `https://restatr.com`, open-source R implementations of Stata commands.
`ivdoctr`:	R package implementing the framework of DiTraglia and García-Jimeno (2021) for eliciting and disciplining identification beliefs (CRAN, 2021).

Graduate Advising

Main or Joint Supervisor:	Antilia Virginie (in progress); Ziyue Wang (in progress); Emily Oehlsen (Coefficient Giving, 2024); Tim Hursey (Afiniti, 2019); Irina Pimenova (Citadel Securities, 2018)
Committee Member:	Lorenzo Braccini (Bank of Italy, 2015); Minchul Shin (UIUC, 2015); Laura Liu (Fed Board of Governors, 2017); Ross Ashkenazi (Cornerstone Research, 2017); Minsu Chang (Georgetown, 2019); Alejandro Sánchez-Becerra (Emory, 2021)

Professional Activities

Refereeing:	American Economic Review, Annals of Statistics, Biometrika, Econometrica, Econometric Reviews, Econometric Theory, Econometrics Journal, International Economic Review, International Journal of Forecasting, International Review of Economics & Finance, Journal of Applied Econometrics, Journal of Business & Economic Statistics, Journal of Development Economics, Journal of Econometrics, Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis, Journal of Multivariate Analysis, Journal of Political Economy Microeconomics, Journal of Statistical Planning and Inference, Labour Economics, Oxford Bulletin of Economics and Statistics, Oxford Economic Papers, Quantitative Economics, Review of Economic Studies
Workshops Organized:	*ICMS Workshop on AI and Economics* (Edinburgh, March 2026) *Bayesian Approaches to Causal Inference* (Oxford, February 2025) *Online Reading Group in Bayesian Inference* (July–September 2024) *High-Dimensional Econometrics and Statistics* (Warren Center, October 2015) *Big Data and Open Science with R* (Warren Center, November 2014)
Service:	Chair of Departmental Research Ethics Committee (Oxford 2023–present) Member of Departmental General Purposes Committee (Oxford 2025–present)
Miscellaneous:	Co-founder `https://sqare.org` Proprietor `https://econometrics.blog`

Presentations

2025–2026: Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago, Imperial College London, Warwick, European University Institute, University College London

2024–2025: CFE-CMStatistics International Joint Conference, University of York, HERC Seminar (Nuffield Department of Population Health)

2022–2023: Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago

2021–2022: Bristol Econometrics Study Group, UC Riverside, Lancaster, Econometric Society European Summer Meeting

2020–2021: Econometric Society World Congress, Fed/NCSU Econometrics Workshop, RES Annual Conference, University of Zurich

2019–2020: *Postponed due to Coronavirus: University of Bristol, University of Groningen, Singapore Management University, National University of Singapore, RES Annual Conference, University of Zurich*

2018–2019: IAAE Annual Conference (Montreal), Philadelphia FRB, Oxford, SEA Annual Meetings, Aarhus

2017–2018: Rice, Syracuse, Cornell, SUNY Binghamton, Boston College, Georgetown, Tilburg, Econometric Society North American Winter Meeting, Rochester

2016–2017: Philadelphia FRB, CEMFI, Manchester, UCL, Cambridge, Oxford, Econometric Society Latin American Meeting (invited), Northwestern, Camp Econometrics XII, Econometric Society North American Summer Meeting

2015–2016: Midwest Econometrics Group Meetings, Chicago Booth, Princeton, Penn State, Greater New York Area Econometrics Colloquium, ISBA World Meeting

2014–2015: Warren Center Symposium, Brown, Rutgers, NBER-NSF Seminar on Bayesian Inference in Econometrics and Statistics

2013–2014: Tilburg University, Tinbergen Institute, Midwest Econometrics Group Meetings, Econometric Society Latin American Econometrics Workshop

2012–2013: Columbia University, University of Wisconsin Madison, Econometric Society North American Summer Meeting (USC)

2011–2012: George Washington, Penn, CREATES (Aarhus), St Andrews, Oxford, Oxford-Man Institute, Queen Mary, University of Vienna, Econometric Society European Summer Meeting (Oslo)